

## Tuvalu

## English

### Mata o Muna 5 — Fakapotopotoga mo Olotou Galuega i te Fenua

### Chapter 5 — Groups and Their Work for the Community

A te Mata o Muna tenei e fakamatala i ai a matākau mo olotou galuega e fai mō te olaga 'lei o te fenua ko Nanumea. E i ai te fakamatalaga toetoe e tala atu e uiga mō matākau i vāega e tolu: te mālō lahi, te fenua, mo te Ekālesia Tuvalu.

This chapter describes the various small community groups and the work they do to improve life in Nanumea. Short descriptions here explain the purpose of each group, which are divided into three categories: the central government, the community, and the Tuvalu Christian Church.

#### Mālō Lahi

#### Central Government

Pēla mo te fai atu i te Mata o Muna 4, a te fenua ko Nanumea e katoatoa ailoa a tena 'kau fakatahi ki pulepulega mo fakanohoga a te mālō lahi. A haga faka te mālō i luga i te fenua, e fakahoa atu katoa mai te mālō i Funafuti ana tino ga'lua. E i ai hoki ni ona hui e tokolua ki te Fale o te Palameni o Tuvalu, telā e fakaoko e lāua a manakoga o te fenua e uiga ki atiakega 'lahi kolā e 'tau o galue mo te mālō.

As noted in Chapter 4, the community of Nanumea lies under the jurisdiction and legal structure of the national government. One of the central government's responsibilities to the Nanumean community is to provide employees to fill various public service roles. Nanumea's two representatives in the national Parliament put forward community requests regarding larger development projects, which are the responsibility of the central government.

A tino Nanumea e mafai o fai ake pelā me i te Kaupule ko te foitino io me ko te hui o te mālō i luga o te fenua, kae ko te Fale Kaupule ko te foitino o te fenua. A te Kaupule ko ia telā e fehokotaki ki ai a te mālō e uiga mo ana manakoga. E i ai he malosī koa oti ni fakaake ki Kaupule o fenua e tusa mo fakateletelega a olotou atiakega, mai te tupe faka'na telā ni fakatokagina hoki ailoa e te fenua fakatahi mo te fesoasoani o te Mālō lahi. Ka ko atiakega 'lahi, pelā mo te ava io me he malae vakalele, e fakaoko katoa e te Pelesitene o te Kaupule ki te Mālō lahi ke galue mo ia.

Nanumeans often say that the Council (Kaupule) is the body which represents the central government on the island, while the Āhiga (Fale Kaupule) is the body representing the community. The central government officially communicates to the community through the Council. Power has been given to the Council of each island to move projects along using the trust funds managed by the island with the assistance of the government; larger projects such as the boat passage or the airstrip are all put forward by the President of the Council to the national government for funding.

Ko ikuga me ko taupulega a te Kaupule e 'tau katoa o pasia mai lalo o te Āhiga, me ko ia te "Falekaupule" o te fenua. A te Āhiga ko te foitino o te fenua e 'kau i ai a toeaina kolā e pānaki mo te tausiga o ana tūu mo faifaiga mō ā hē mafai olotou tiakina valevale e te Mālō. A te Mālō lahi koa taumafai nei o fakatoka he fakafealofaniga 'lei o foitino konei e lua a te mālō. Ko tena uiga lā koa malosī atu a te pulepulega o te fenua. E manakogina ko te Pulefenua, mo maga o aliki (Tokofitu) pela hoki mo toeaina i te Āhiga, lātou katoa ke loto'tahi, kae ke 'kau fakatahi hoki i te faiga o galuega.

Resolutions and minutes of meetings of the Council are approved by the Āhiga, which is the community body including, particularly, the elders responsible for preserving the customs and traditions that the government must not violate. The central government has made efforts to bring these two governing bodies into a workable arrangement through the Falekaupule Act, which is intended to strengthen governance of the island. The High Chief (Pulefenua), the Council of Chiefs (Tokofitu) and the elders in the Āhiga all need to come together to work for the good of the island.

#### Fakapotopotoga a te Fenua — Feitu: Haumaefa mo Lolua

#### Island Groups — Sides (Feitu): Haumaefa and Lolua

Hē motuhia a feitu e lua, Lolua mo Haumaefa, ko fakapotopotoga tafahili i te tāua konei a te fenua ka e i ai hoki ni fakapotopotoga tai foliki e i ai ni olotou vaega tāua e fai mō te fenua.

Nanumea's two village "sides," Haumaefa and Lolua, are without doubt the most important community-wide groups. However, some other smaller groups also contribute to the island in important ways.

E hē iloa tonu me ni ma'fua pehea a igoa konei, kae konei a igoa ni fakaigoa ki ai a fa'kai me ko feitu fenua e lua o

Though the origin of these names is lost in time, every Nanumean knows whether he or she is a member of

Nanumea. Te tino Nanumea e mafai a iloa o iloa me ko ia he Haumaefa io me he Lolua, me ni fakavae mai a iloa e o lotou tupuga mai mua.

Lolua mo Haumaefa ko pou ma'losi konei kae fakamoemoegina o te fenua, kae pelā hoki a pule o te fenua. E tofu a faitu fenua konei mo olotou takitaki. Ka e i ai hoki a iloa ni olotou fakateletelega mo olotou atiakega e aofaga a lātou ki ai mo te 'lei hoki a iloa o lātou i tulaga faka faitu. E i ai ni galuega e fai faka te fenua, kolā e ga'lue fakatahi katoa a tino o te fenua ki ai, kae ko te lahiga o taimi e faka faitu katoa. I te lahi o te agaga fakataufai telā koa mafai ai o 'vave a galuega.

I te fakafiafiaga o "Pō 'Lahi," a fiafiaga e māhāni o fai a iloa i faitu. E pelā hoki mo tahaoga tenei ko te ano, mo tahaoga ake hoki i te taimi tenei. E mafai o lavea i konei a te lahi o te loto ki te faitu, me i tamatāne e hē 'tapala o olo o 'hala ika, faitili, 'lama, olo ki moana o āhi a te akau, pelā hoki tamāfine i te fakatokatokaga o meakai mo mea inu.

Kae fai a iloa e tumau a te maopoopo mo te 'gali o tahaoga a tamatāne/tamāfine, e mafai o toe talia manafai e avake he fakatagi ke toe tolo atu a tahaoga ki he tahi me he lua potapu ke toe faopoopo. Telā e i ai he taimi e mafai o fakahae ake a te mea tenei ko te "fai hoa." Te fai hoa ko tāgata mai Lolua koa hoa, me koa 'kau mo fāfine a Haumaefa, kae ko tāgata Haumaefa mo fāfine a Lolua.

Lolua or Haumaefa, since their families have been longstanding members of one or the other side.

Haumaefa and Lolua are two strong pillars of community life, and of community leadership. Each of the sides has its own leadership structure. The two sides normally relate in opposition to each other, although each side also plans activities and development projects for its own well-being. Members of the two village sides often collaborate in community-wide work projects but these projects are usually organized as a division between the two sides, since competing against each other makes the work go faster.

"Big Days" festivities (Pō 'Lahi) are also organized using the village sides. This includes ano and other activities during this time. The strength of the side organization is shown at this time because everything is structured around them. Examples include when young men from each faitu go out to fish for flying fish or for bonito further out in the ocean; or when young women prepare food and drink for the fishermen.

If many young men and women are participating enthusiastically in "Big Days" festivities, they usually request that the elders extend the length of celebration and games by an additional week or two. If this happens, there may come a time for the custom of fai hoa, "taking partners." Fai hoa is a reversal of the normal opposition between the two village sides, since now the men of Lolua partner with the women of Haumaefa, and vice versa.

## Potopotonga Fo'liki ifo i Nanumea

- Volenitia: he matākau a tāgata o te fenua koa leva ni fakatū mō luani ki te fenua. Ko te galuega a lātou koi tumau nei o fai, ko te luani ki te fenua i te keliga o poko o tino 'mate.
- Fafine (Katoa) o te Fenua: ko lātou e tausi te āhiga ke 'ma, pelā hoki mo te tātuga, fakatahi ki ai ko mea tau atiakega a fāfine i luga o te fenua.
- Tineiafi mo Suluelise: konei hoki a fapopotoga a fāfine e lua, e lahi a te fakamoemoegina e te fenua. E luani ki te fenua, ka e luani hoki ki te Lotu Kelisiano (EKT) i avanoaga e fia maua i ai a te olotou luani.
- Talavou: ko te fakapotopotoga a tamatāne mo tamāfine. I pō nei, ni 'fuli a te pulepulega ki te fenua, ko te mea a tama katoa o te fenua (e taga lotu katoa) kē mafai o kau fakatahi i he putukau e tahi.

## Smaller Community Groups in Nanumea

- Volunteers: A long-standing men's group that assists the community in development work and also assists any family that needs help. Their most long-standing job is digging graves when a community member dies.
- Women of the Island: Collectively, the community's women take care of cleaning the āhiga and the cemetery, and participate in women's development projects on the island.
- Tineiafi and Suluelise: The island relies heavily on these two women's groups. They assist the community, as well as the Church, in any situation where their help is requested. They also have their own fund-raising projects.
- Talavou or "Unmarried Youth": This group consists of all the community's young men and women. The Talavou is now under the direction of the island as a whole in order that all the youth of the island (regardless of their religion) can be included within a single organization.

## Fakapotopotoga a te Lotu — Potopotoga e Fā

## Church Groups — The Four Church Work Groups (Potopotoga)

Pelā mo te fai atu i te Mata o Muna 4, ni faigatā ailoa o talia fakavave e tino Nanumea a te tālaiga o te tala ki te Fulihaiga-fou. Koa 150 tauhaga (mai te 1872-2026) a te matua o te Tala 'Lei i luga i Nanumea nei. A tātou ni 'noho muamua mai lalo o te tausiga a te Lonitona Misionale Sosaiete (LMS) telā e tū i Samoa, ke oko mai ki te taimi ni 'vae mai ai a tatou mai Samoa i te tauhaga 1968.

A potopotonga e fā (ko Vakalele, Usitai, Kalofia mo Lesili) koa aogā tonu o fesoasoani ki te lotu. Ni kāmata a potopotoga konei i te taimi ni fāite i ai a te faletapu e igoa ki a Loto Lelei i loto i te 1930. Ni aogā kī te fakatokaga o te fakavae o te faletapu, i te taliga o fatu, kilikili mo one, pelā hoki mo te faiga o lahe mō fai a te faletapu.

Fakamuli ifo i te 1950, ni toe fakaogā hoki a potopotoga konei i te faitega o te fa'kai mo fale o te ākoga ko Tafegatua School. Ko Tāfega he ākoga a te lotu LMS a te fenua, telā ni fakatū i te faitū ki matagi o te namo. E fā a fale 'moe o tamaliki o te ākoga ni fāite, kae ni fakaigoa hoki ailoa ki igoa o potopotoga konei e fā.

Kae ko te lua o galuega a potopotoga ko te halahalaga a sene mō te taimi o faigā lotu a potopotoga i te Tauhaga Fou i tauhaga takitahi. A te lotu fai fakatahi a te fenua, e fai ailoa i te pō muamua o Ianuali i te vaeluapō. E lahi 'kī hoki a te loto fakataufai i te mea tenei, me i lotu a potopotoga e tolu konei koi 'toe, e taumafai ailoa ko lātou ke uke ia me ke hili atu a olotou sene i lo o potopotoga kolā koa oti a olotou lotu.

As was explained in Chapter 4, Nanumeans initially found it difficult to convert to an entirely new religion. The Gospel has been on Nanumea for over 150 years now (from 1872-2026). Initially Tuvalu's church operated under the jurisdiction of the Samoan-based London Missionary Society, based in London, until it split off in 1968.

There are four very important groups which help with the church's work, te potopotoga. They are named: Vakalele, Usitai, Kalofia, and Lesili. These groups originated in the 1930's at the time that Nanumea's church, Loto Lelei, was built. These work groups helped in the construction of the church's foundation, carrying the rocks, sand and gravel that were needed.

Later, in the 1950s, the four potopotoga work groups were used to build the school at Tafega-Atua. This was a LMS church school which was built on the matagi side of the lagoon across from the village. The school had four dormitories for children, each given the name of one of the four work groups.

Another responsibility of the four potopotoga groups was to raise money through their church services at New Year. These begin with a community-wide service at midnight on January 1st. The spirit of competition at these potopotoga church services is enormous, as each group tries to make their donation larger than those of the groups before it.

## Potopotoga Fo'liki a te Ekalesia Kelisiano Tuvalu i Nanumea

- Kau fai galuega: e aofia i ai a te Kau-failauga mo te Kau-tiakono. Ko lātou konei ko pou 'malosi a te tofi o te fenua. Kolā e aofaga mō te teletele 'lei o te galuega a te Atua i luga o te fenua.
- Komiti fāfine (a te Lotu): ko lātou e teuteu a te faletapu, 'mulu kae auli laugatu e 'fola ki ai a te tulaga mo te taipola, fakatoka te teu o te mate.
- Aogapehe: ko lātou e fakatoka a pehe o te lotu i taimi katoa e fai i ai a tapuakiga i pōtapu mo pō-tolu o vaiaso takitahi.
- Faiākoga pōtapu: ko lātou e luani ki te faifeau i te akoakoga o tamaliki ki mea tau Tuhitapu, kae ke maua e lātou a te olaga Kelisiano tonu.
- Kakeatu: he tahi hoki o foitino o te lotu, telā e māhani o 'luku tautino sene mō fesoasoani ki atiakega a te lotu.

## Smaller Groups of the Christian Church in Nanumea

- Work Groups, which include the Lay Preachers and Deacons, all of whom are strong supporters of the island Pastor. These groups make decisions on how best to move forward the church's work on the island.
- Women's Church Committee: This group of church women cleans the church, washes and irons the cloths used to cover the pulpit and altar table, prepares funeral flowers.
- Choir: Members prepare hymns for the Sunday and Wednesday church services each week. They also join the Pastor and Women's Committee in funeral services.
- Sunday School Teachers: A group of teachers assists the Pastor in teaching children about the Bible to help them live a Christian life while still growing up.
- "Advancement" (Kakeatu): This church group collects funds to help with the further development of the church.

## He Luani me he Amoga 'Mafa?

## A Benefit or a Heavy Burden?

E hē motuhia a te mau faufauga ni fakavae ki ai a te faiga o matākau 'fou konei ko te tai faka'leiga o te fenua mo ona tagata. Kae a fakapotopotoga luani konei ke mafai o fai a lātou pelā me ni amoga 'mafa ki tino kolā e mafau'fau a lātou o luani ki ai. E i ai nei he mea e tupu penei ki tino, tino i uta i Nanumea pelā hoki mo tino Nanumea i fenua ake?

Kae pehea i ai kia lātou kolā e hē lahi a te olotou maumea e mafai o maua, kae ko mea fai a matākau koa hohoko ailoa. A te pogai e tahi o te mea tenei, ko tino o he kāiga e tahi kae uke a matakau valevale e 'kau i ai. Penei, e 'tau mo lātou o luani ki galuega faka faitu, pelā hoki mo olotou potopotoga, lafolafoga ki te lotu, kae kau hoki i te Tineiafi me ko Sulu Elise, te Komiti Fāfine, te Talavou...

I pō nei, e fanake ailoa o lahi a te kehekehega o maumea e mafai o maua e kāiga takitahi. E i ai ni kāiga koa tai feoloolo ailoa a te maumea o lātou, kae ko kāiga ake koi tai foliki a te avanoaga ki sene, pelā hoki mo mea i tafa o te sene. Atu lā e 'tau mo tātou o aofaga ake faka'lei a te fakafokifoki o te fia maua ki he luani mai matakau ke faka'pau ake mo te hekehekega mai maumea e maua e kāiga.

Undoubtedly, the original idea behind the formation of any new group is that it should improve the life of the community and its people. Nonetheless, beneficial organizations have the potential to become burdens on the very people they mean to help. Could this be happening now for some people, both those who live in Nanumea and for Nanumeans who live in other locations?

Especially people whose resources are limited can find the groups' incessant requests for support overwhelming. One reason for this is that the members of a single family have responsibilities to so many different groups. For example, they should help in the work of their faitu, their potopotoga, contribute to the church, join Tineiafi or Sulu Elise, help the Komiti Fāfine, the Seimeana...

Today, differences in the resources that families have are increasing. Some are quite wealthy, while others have little access to money or other resources. Perhaps we need to consider how the assistance repeatedly requested by these groups balances with the differences that exist in family resources? Could we find some way to make sure that the well-being of all families is protected, and that community groups remain a help for all, rather than a burden for some?

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